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Enloe Health braces for patient surge with impending closure of Glenn Medical Center's Emergency Room

Bella Barbosa

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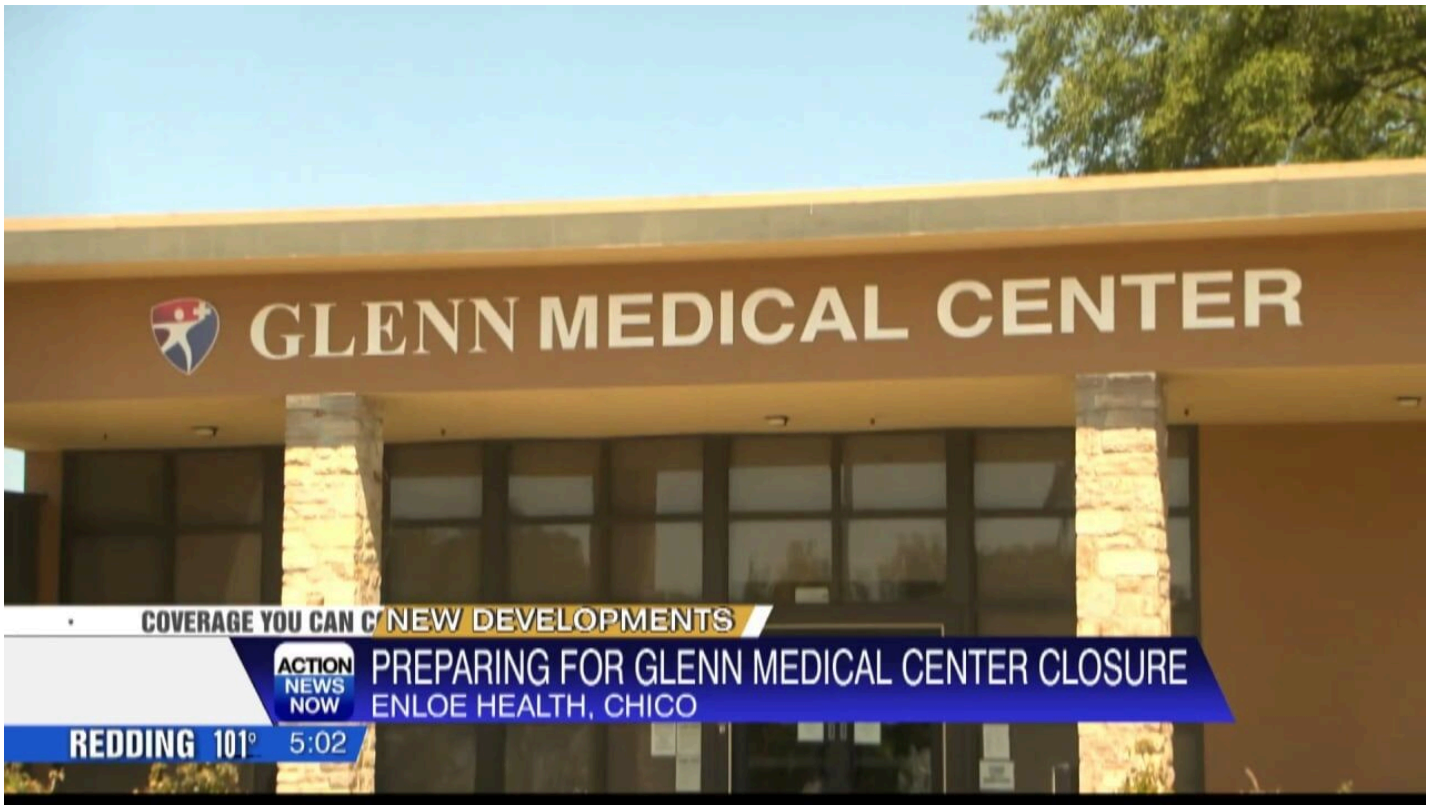

Action News Now reporter Bella Barbosa reports from Enloe Health in Chico. In a statement, Enloe Health says they are concerned about the closure of the Emergency Room at Glenn Medical Center and say they are continuing to review available resources to ensure their readiness to absorb the anticipated increase in patients that will be coming to Enloe Health's Emergency Department.

CHICO, Calif. - The Glenn Medical Center's emergency department is set to close its doors on September 30, three weeks earlier than initially planned. This closure, attributed to staffing shortages, is expected to impact nearby healthcare facilities.

The early closure highlights the increasing challenges rural communities face in accessing healthcare. Residents from areas like Paradise have already been traveling to Chico for emergency services due to the absence of a local emergency department since damage from the Camp Fire closed Feather River Hospital in 2018.

With the Glenn Medical Center’s emergency room closure, Enloe Health ER staff could be serving even more people from multiple counties across Northern California.

In a statement, Enloe Health officials expressed concern about the closure and shared that staff are reviewing resources to handle the expected increase in patients coming into the emergency department.

The statement also said that Enloe Health anticipates that Glenn County leaders will work with the owners of Glenn Medical Center to determine a path forward to serve residents of Glenn County.

Enloe Health provides air ambulance services within a 75-mile radius, which includes Glenn County. They also offer air ambulance memberships to ensure that members will not face out-of-pocket costs in the event they require flight care services.

In an effort to bridge the gap in care, the Willows Fire Department announced plans to expand its services by January 20-26 to include an advanced life support non-transport program.

Bella Barbosa
Multimedia Journalist

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